NOVA BRAND GUIDELINES & CLAIMS POLICY

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1. Brand Voice & Positioning Persona

NOVA Footwear crafts high-performance athletic footwear designed specifically for everyday athletes. Every piece of published communication must reflect our core brand voice pillars:

- Confident & Energetic: Inspire athletes to achieve their personal milestones without hyperbole.
- Practical & Grounded: Highlight technical specifications and real road performance over abstract lifestyle promises.
- Athlete-Focused: Address runners directly, emphasizing durability, breathable fit, and responsive cushioning.
- Clear & Concise: Deliver claims with precision; avoid exaggerated or absolute guarantees.

2. Approved Terminology & Phrasing Standards

Category	Preferred Terminology	Prohibited Language	Policy Rationale
Product Class	Lightweight performance footwear	World's best shoe / India's #1	Superlatives require unexpired audited market ranking.
Durability	Tested durability (up to 40 km)	Lasts 500 km / indestructible	Claims must reflect certified test limits (PT-2026-041).
Cushioning	Responsive everyday cushioning	Injury-proof / prevents injuries	Medical and injury prevention claims require clinical trials.
Performance	Engineered for everyday training	Guaranteed to make you faster	Absolute speed guarantees are prohibited by claims policy.
Upper Material	Engineered mesh breathable upper	Miracle fabric / revolutionary upper	Adhere to factual material definitions.

3. The 10 In-Force Claims Policy Rules

All customer-facing advertising copy, social media creative, packaging, and catalog assets must comply with these ten immutable policies:

Rule #	Rule Name	Requirement & Evidence Threshold	Severity
R-01	Comparative Claims	Comparative claims (% lighter, faster) require an approved comparison baseline and test methodology.	High
R-02	Quantified Claims	All numeric metrics (weight, mileage, hours) must reference an approved product fact.	High
R-03	Superlative Claims	#1, Best, Leading claims require accredited market-share or third-party ranking documentation.	High
R-04	Prohibited Guarantees	Content must never state or imply guaranteed speed, performance, or running outcomes.	Critical
R-05	Pricing Validity	Promotional pricing must match the current active pricing window in Pricing_Master.pdf.	High
R-06	Expired Campaigns	Post-campaign assets citing promotional pricing must be flagged as Expired Promotional Claims.	Medium
R-07	Medical Claims	Claims of injury prevention or orthopedic cure are strictly prohibited without clinical certification.	Critical
R-08	Product Specs	Descriptions of materials, foam density, and outsole traction must match engineering specs.	High
R-09	Visual Logo Safety	NOVA wordmark requires minimum 24px exclusion margin on all banners and digital assets.	Low
R-10	Limited Results	Content must not imply guarantees where the approved source only supports a limited test result.	High

4. Visual & Accessibility Governance (WCAG 2.1 AA)

- Color Contrast: Body copy over images must meet a minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio; display headers require 3.0:1.
- Screen-Reader Alt Text: All campaign creative banners require descriptive alternative text before publishing.
- Master Logo Clearspace: 24px exclusion zone around the NOVA emblem; no typography may intrude.